

SCENE 0: BEFORE AND AS THE AUDIENCE ENTER

ACTOR

(Sit in your chair, reading a book and listening to the music on the 'radio'). Players will begin playing along with the 'radio' music.

RIGHT BEFORE THE SHOW STARTS:

Recorded Message will play:

“Dear Audience. Thank you for coming to D, we, you, me. As part of the show, you will be asked to participate at various times, perhaps with objects, or with your cell phones. When cell phone participation occurs, a QR code will be projected onto the screen. Your participation is valued and encouraged, but not required. Please enjoy the show.”

SCENE 1: STORM

ACTOR

*continue reading for a beat, then **turn off the radio** in an exaggerated manner. PLAYERS stop playing.*

Continue reading. PLAYERS will begin playing storm sounds. PLAYER 1 gets up to interact with audience. Audience will get out their aluminum foil and wait for their cue.

*After a few minutes, TECH will CLAP, and PLAYERS and AUDIENCE will make thunder sounds. **After the first CLAP**, get up and boil the kettle, then sit back down. There will be **three more claps**.*

*When recorded **creaking sounds** start playing through the speakers, look around towards the source but continue reading. As soon as the kettle finishes boiling, get up and make a cup of tea and sit back down.*

*When you hear a **car alarm**, get up and walk to the imaginary door (on the kitchen/living room side). Open the door in an exaggerated gesture, look around for a beat, and close the door. Sounds will get louder and quieter as you open and close door. Sit back down and continue reading, drink tea if cool enough.*

*Once PLAYERS and AUDIENCE start joining in with **creaking noises**, get up and start walking around, trying to find the source of the sound, but not finding anything. Pace, drink your tea, on edge. Feel free to walk into the audience trying to identify the sounds, but don't look directly at any audience member. You cannot see them and are unaware of their presence. Ignore them if they try to interact.*

As creaks continue and become more intense, return to your chair, pick up your book, sit there for a few seconds looking around.

ACTOR

Hello?

(audio will be muted; players and audience will stop playing. Wait for a response for a beat, then resume reading your book).

As sounds start up again, throw your book to the ground, stand up, and walk to the front of the stage.

ACTOR

(loudly)

HELLO?

*(audio will be muted again. When **D** says "**Hello**," jump a little.*

D

(from audience cellphones)

Hello

LIGHTS GO DOWN

SCENE 2: FIRST ENCOUNTER

ACTOR

(turn cell phone flashlight on and look around, trying not to shine it directly into audience eyes. Keep tone light)
Show yourself!

D *(from speakers)*

You won't be able to see me, but you can hear me!

ACTOR

(Turn towards sound source - speakers)
That's pretty ominous.

D

I'm not here to harm you. Are you lonely?

ACTOR

(Turn your cell phone light off stand in stillness. AUDIENCE and PLAYERS will interact via a cellphone interaction, sounds will come from players and speakers. The results of an audience poll will appear on the screen. Wait for the screen to go dark again to continue the scene.

ACTOR

(Once the screen goes dark turn your cellphone light back on.)
I'm super lonely

D

Then allow me to stay

ACTOR

(resigned) Fine, you can stay *(turn cellphone light off when lights come on again)*.

LIGHTS COME BACK ON

D

That's better!

ACTOR

(Sit back down in your chair, sighing)

For this section of dialogue between ACTOR & D, ACTOR will improvise some questions for D, and D will generate a response. Players will follow the **formula** on the next page.

ACTOR's GUIDE FOR IMPROVISING QUESTIONS:

Before you're ready to speak, press your button to record. When you stop talking, press to stop recording.

Some guidelines for the conversation:

Alternate between asking some brief questions about where D is from and asking them so light questions about their likes and dislikes. If D starts to lead you too much in a direction you don't want to pursue, feel free to shut it down and redirect with something mundane. When D asks you questions about yourself, do not mention anything too personal, keep it conversational. **Avoid asking why they are here or what they want from you.** If D contradicts themselves, you can call them out. You can make the structure of the conversation kind of absurd and non-sensical.

Some ideas for questions:

- Who are you?
- Where are you from?
- Do you like drinking tea?
- Can you see me?
- What do you look like?
- What's your favorite color
- Have you ever flown a kite?

After about 5 minutes of conversation, start stretching and acting sleepy. TECH will take this as a cue and start pre-recorded dialogue again.

TOOTHBRUSH SEQUENCE

D

You seem tired. Perhaps you should go to sleep.

ACTOR

*I am tired. I'll brush my teeth and then go to sleep (hold up your cardboard mouth in front of yours and start brushing it. As you start brushing, a large two-minute timer will appear on the screen behind you. PLAYERS and AUDIENCE will start brushing their toothbrushes on sheets of paper. Stop brushing when the **timer goes off** and **lie down in the bed.***

ACTOR

Will you still be here when I wake up?

D

You'll have to wait and see

ACTOR

(Go to sleep. As you sleep, lights will dim, and AUDIENCE and PLAYERS will perform SCENE 3: SLEEP SCENE, playing through various melodies. This will last for a while).

SCENE 3: SLEEP SCENE

ACTOR

*(At the end of SLEEP SCENE, AUDIENCE will begin playing **alarm sounds** on their cellphones. Begin stirring. After about 30 seconds, get up and hit you alarm clock. Sounds will immediately be muted.)*

SCENE 4: COFFEE

ACTOR

Hello? Are you still there?

Silence for a beat

ACTOR

Hello?

D

Hello

ACTOR

(Jump a little bit). I'm too tired for this. Don't talk to me again until I've had my coffee. (Start making coffee, including boiling the kettle, putting the coffee in the French press, pouring water over it. Wait for a few mins for it to brew. PLAYERS and AUDIENCE will be playing a coffee song which will include some sung text through audience cellphones).

ACTOR

When your coffee is ready, pour it into two mugs. Wait for it to cool a little, then take a pronounced sip. This will change the music. Go and sit in your chair, sipping your coffee sporadically. D will speak after PLAYERS stop playing

D (to audience)

I can't drink, do any of you want this? Raise your hand if you'd like it. (PLAYER 1 will hand a cup of coffee to an audience member. You can just be sitting and drinking your coffee.)

SCENE FIVE: WALK

ACTOR

(After taking a few sips) Ok, I feel great now. Let's go for a walk, but I need to get ready first.

D

Let me know when you're ready.

SET CHANGE *Move everything backwards to give ACTOR room to walk*

ACTOR

(As the stage change happens, bend down to tie your shoes. PLAYERS and audience will perform ELEVATOR MUSIC. They will interact with the audience and sing a song together. Wait for D to come in again before straightening up). (aside: I'd like to think of another getting ready action here).

D

Ok, you can stop playing elevator music!

ACTOR

(As you hear D, begin gently walking in place. Player 2 will start handing out marbles to the audience, and they will start shaking them).

D

What is that noise?

ACTOR

*Cricket frogs (As PLAYER 2 continues to hand out bags, walk in silence). PLAYERS 1 & 3 will start to play frog sounds. After a minute or two, AUDIENCE and PLAYERS will **stop playing**, which is your cue to speak.*

ACTOR

(You can stop “walking” now)
Can you teach me your language?

D

I can certainly try.

ACTOR

How do you say calm?

D

Like this

(Players create a sound.)

ACTOR

(Try to recreate the sound made by the players with your voice a few times.)
How was that?

D

Not bad...

ACTOR

How do you say friend?

PLAYERS 1, 2, & 3

Play Language instructions with different sounds

ACTOR

(Try to recreate the sound made by the players with your voice a few times.)

For the last sound, the audience will be invited to join in. They will need some time to get ready, so wait for a couple of minutes before the next dialogue. You can take pictures on your phone.

ACTOR

How do you say home?

(As audience members start recording themselves saying the word, try to recreate the sound made by the players with your voice a few times. Audience sounds will start to come through the speakers)

ACTOR

(When the recordings stop playing back through the speakers) How am I doing?

D

You're doing great

ACTOR

I wish I could see your face, to see whether you're laughing at me

D

Imaging what you want me to look like

ACTOR

I can't even begin to imagine it

Moment of silence

D

I want you to come with me

ACTOR

Where?

D

To my home. For good. With no possibility of return

ACTOR

Why?

D

Because I'm lonely

ACTOR

(Pause for a beat)

I'll think about it. Let's go home and make some tea.

(Turn and "walk" in the opposite direction while stage is reset).

As you walk, set will change, and audience will start uploading their questions to a screen. Small melodic fragments will start to play. Allow some time for audience to come up with their questions, a couple of minutes.

ACTOR

(Once stage is reset, "re-enter" the home, take your shoes off, then put the kettle on).

SCENE SIX: QUESTIONS

ACTOR

I have a few more questions before I make a decision about going with you.
(*Sit back in your chair and wait for the questions to appear on the screen.*)

TECH

Display instructions for audience to ring their bell if they like the answer or shake their marbles if they find it suspicious.

QUESTIONS PROGRESSION

ACTOR

Questions will appear on the screen. As they appear, ask them by recording them as in the previous section. Feel free to change the wording a little. Audience members may submit more questions as your conversation is happening.

The last question that comes up on the screen will be “Alright, one last question. Is there tea where you’re from?” This is your cue that the questions are ending.

ACTOR

(When you see the question about tea)

Alright, one last question. Is there tea where you’re from?

D

I wouldn’t want to ruin the surprise.

Audience members will vote on whether you should go by shaking their marbles or bells.

ACTOR

(Walk to the front of the stage, signal for the audience to stop playing).

What about of you? Do you want to come too? If you do, come down here.

PLAYERS 1, 2, & 3

Put your instruments down and go to the stage to join the others.

ACTOR

(Wait for audience members to come down to the stage. Once it seems like no more will come)

Ok, let’s go!

LIGHTS

Blackout

END